

Delightful Displays

Also Remember...

- Warranties from manufacturers are usually valid for one year. However, some manufacturers such as Microtek and LG offer a three- year warranty on their products.
- Integrated speakers, USB ports and a user friendly On Screen Display are other features that you might want to consider.
- Models that come with 'flat' picture tubes are generally more expensive.

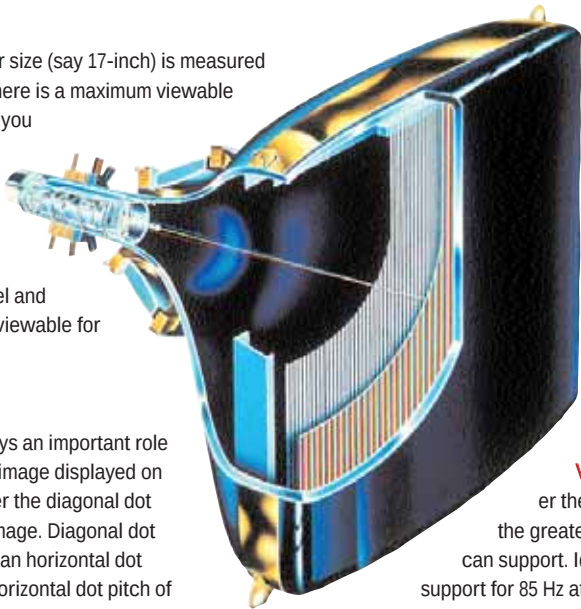
This is the bulkiest and costliest component of any PC. Since you don't really go around changing your monitor every other month, it pays to make the right choice the first time around. There are basically two technologies being used in CRT displays today— the more widely used shadow mask technology and Sony's proprietary Aperture Grille technology. The latter produces crisper and more realistic images.

Monitors are usually bought by size with the 14- and 15-inch models being the most common. 17-inch models are seeing a massive growth in popularity, while 19- and 21-inch monitors are the preserve of graphic and design professionals.

SMART TIPS

Viewable area: Monitor size (say 17-inch) is measured diagonally. However, there is a maximum viewable area specification that you need to pay closer attention to in CRT monitors. This would be in the region of about 13.8 inch viewable for a 15-inch model and close to about 16 inch viewable for most 17-inch monitors.

Dot pitch: Dot pitch plays an important role in the crispness of the image displayed on the monitor. The smaller the diagonal dot pitch, the crisper the image. Diagonal dot pitch is more critical than horizontal dot pitch. For instance, a horizontal dot pitch of 0.24 mm usually corresponds to a diagonal dot pitch of approximately 0.28 mm. Most 15-inch monitors come with 0.28 mm diagonal dot pitch, whereas for the 17-inch models it's between 0.24 mm to 0.28 mm.



Screen Geometry:

Screen geometry refers to the proper display of shapes such as circles, squares and polygons. The monitor should be capable of displaying images without any geometric distortion. In inferior monitors you will find that circles end up looking slightly elliptical in shape.

Video bandwidth: The higher the bandwidth of the monitor, the greater the range of resolutions it can support. Ideally, you should look for support for 85 Hz at the resolution you normal-

ly use, to avoid the flicker that will invariably take place at refresh rates of 60 Hz. This can add considerably to reducing fatigue, especially for people that spend a major part of the day sitting in front of their computers.

	Office productivity	Home and Internet	Graphics and design professionals
You need	A display that reproduces crisp text for office applications	You are looking for display that fits into your overall PC budget.	A large display with a high resolution support and excellent colour reproduction
Look for	15-inch monitors	14--inch, 15-inch, or 17-inch monitors	19-inch, or 21-inch monitors
Our pick	ViewSonic E53	ViewSonic PS775, Philips 107T	Samsung SyncMaster 955DF, LG StudioWorks 995e, LG StudioWorks 221U
Price range	Up to Rs 8,000	Up to Rs 12,000	Rs 20,000 and above



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